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In-situ epi growth rate control of crystal thickness micro-balancing sensor

Abstract

A method and apparatus for processing semiconductor substrates is described herein. The apparatus includes one or more growth monitors disposed within an exhaust system of a deposition chamber. The growth monitors are quartz crystal film thickness monitors and are configured to measure the film thickness grown on the growth monitors while a substrate is being processed within the deposition chamber. The growth monitors are connected to a controller, which adjusts the heating apparatus and gas flow apparatus settings during the processing operations. Measurements from the growth monitors as well as other sensors within the deposition chamber are used to adjust processing chamber models of the deposition chamber as substrates are processed therein.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application claims benefit of Indian provisional patent application serial number 202141024131, filed May 31, 2021, which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

Field

(2) Embodiments of the present disclosure generally relate to apparatus and methods for fabricating semiconductor devices. More specifically, apparatus disclosed herein relate to exhaust assemblies and growth rate sensors within a semiconductor process chamber. Methods of using the same are also disclosed.

Description of the Related Art

(3) Semiconductor substrates are processed for a wide variety of applications, including the fabrication of integrated devices and microdevices. During processing, the substrate is positioned on a susceptor within a process chamber. The susceptor is supported by a support shaft, which is rotatable about a central axis. Precise control over a heating source is preferred to uniformly heat the substrate within strict tolerances. The temperature of the substrate can affect the uniformity of the material deposited on the substrate.

(4) The ability to precisely control substrate temperatures within the process chamber has a significant impact on throughput and production yields. Conventional process chambers have difficulty meeting temperature control criteria needed to fabricate next generation devices while meeting ever increasing demands for improved production yields and faster throughput. Process gases are flowed across a process volume within the process chamber. The process gases are flowed parallel to the substrate surface from one side of the process chamber to an opposite side of the process chamber. Heating and gas flow within the process chamber may be adjusted to improve film deposition rates across the substrates. Current sensors within the process chamber have limited

resolution and the addition of additional sensors increases the downtime of the process chamber and increases the cost of ownership. Substrates processed between calibration and measurement operations also have less precise deposition rates due to changes in chamber conditions. Current sensors within a process chamber include pyrometers, but pyrometers have limited resolution. Downstream pressure sensors fail to provide adequate partial pressure estimates across other portions of the process chamber.

(5) Therefore, a need exists for improved exhaust apparatus and growth rate monitoring.

SUMMARY

(6) The present disclosure generally relates to process chambers for semiconductor processing. In one embodiment, an exhaust passage body for substrate processing is described. The exhaust passage body includes a first exhaust plenum, a first exhaust entry opening, a first plurality of fins, a first exhaust exit opening, a first baffle plate, and at least one growth monitor. The first exhaust plenum is formed through a first end of the exhaust passage body and fluidly connected to the first exhaust plenum. The first plurality of fins are disposed adjacent to the first exhaust entry opening within the first exhaust plenum. The first exhaust exit opening is formed through a second end of the exhaust passage body and fluidly connected to the first exhaust plenum. The first baffle plate is disposed adjacent to the first exhaust exit opening and configured to narrow the width of the first exhaust plenum. The at least one growth monitor is disposed downstream of the first baffle plate and configured to measure a thickness of a material deposited on the growth monitor.

(7) In another embodiment, an exhaust system for substrate processing is described. The exhaust system includes an exhaust passage body, an exhaust plenum, an exhaust entry opening, a plurality of fins, an exhaust exit opening, at least one baffle plate, and at least one growth monitor. The exhaust entry opening is formed through a first end of the exhaust passage body and has an entry width. The exhaust entry opening is configured to fluidly connect the exhaust plenum and a process volume. The plurality of fins are disposed adjacent to the exhaust entry opening within the exhaust plenum. The exhaust exit opening is formed through a second end of the exhaust passage body and fluidly connected to the exhaust plenum. The at least one baffle plate is disposed adjacent to the exhaust exit opening and is configured to narrow the width of the exhaust plenum to an exit width less than the entry width. The at least one growth monitor is disposed downstream of the baffle plate and configured to measure a thickness of a material deposited on the growth monitor. An exhaust collector is coupled to the exhaust passage body at the exhaust exit.

(8) In another embodiment, a processing system for substrate processing is described. The processing system includes a chamber body forming a process volume, a substrate support disposed within the process volume of the chamber body, an upper window disposed above the substrate support, and a lower window disposed below the substrate support. Each of the upper window and the lower window further define the process volume. An injector is disposed through one side of the chamber body and is configured to introduce a process gas to the process volume. An exhaust system is disposed through a second side of the chamber body opposite the injector. The exhaust system includes an exhaust passage body, an exhaust plenum disposed through the exhaust passage body, an exhaust entry opening, a plurality of fins, an exhaust exit opening, at least one baffle plate, and at least one growth monitor. The exhaust entry opening is formed through a first end of the exhaust passage body. The exhaust entry opening is configured to fluidly connect the exhaust plenum and the process volume. The plurality of fins are disposed within the exhaust plenum. The exhaust exit opening is formed through a second end of the exhaust passage body and is fluidly connected to the exhaust plenum. The at least one baffle plate is disposed downstream of the plurality of fins and configured to narrow the width of the exhaust plenum to an exit width less than the entry width. The at least one growth monitor is disposed downstream of the baffle plate and configured to measure a thickness of a material deposited on the growth monitor.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) So that the manner in which the above recited features of the present disclosure can be understood in detail, a more particular description of the disclosure, briefly summarized above, may be had by reference to embodiments, some of which are illustrated in the appended drawings. It is to be noted, however, that the appended drawings illustrate only exemplary embodiments and are therefore not to be considered limiting of its scope, may admit to other equally effective embodiments.

(2) FIG. 1 is a schematic illustration of a deposition chamber, according to embodiments of the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates a cross-sectional plan view of the deposition chamber of FIG. 1, according to embodiments of the present disclosure.

(4) FIG. 3A illustrates a cross-sectional plan view of the exhaust system of the deposition chamber of FIG. 1, according to embodiments of the present disclosure.

(5) FIG. 3B illustrates a cross-sectional side view of the exhaust system of the deposition chamber of FIG. 1, according to embodiments of the present disclosure.

(6) FIG. 4 illustrates a growth monitor for use within the deposition chamber of FIG. 1, according to embodiments of the present disclosure.

(7) FIG. 5 illustrates a control schematic for use within the deposition chamber of FIG. 1, according to embodiments of the present disclosure.

(8) FIG. 6 illustrates a method of adjusting process conditions within the deposition chamber of FIG. 1, according to embodiments of the present disclosure.

(9) To facilitate understanding, identical reference numerals have been used, where possible, to designate identical elements that are common to the figures. It is contemplated that elements and features of one embodiment may be beneficially incorporated in other embodiments without further recitation.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(10) The present disclosure relate to exhaust assemblies and growth rate sensors within a semiconductor process chamber. The growth rate sensors are quartz crystal film thickness monitors and enable measurement of a film thickness on the growth rate sensor. The film thickness on the growth rate sensor is equated to a growth rate on the substrate within the process chamber. The thickness measurements may then be utilized to adjust one or more process controls within the process volume of the process chamber and improve film growth across the substrate.

(11) Quartz crystal monitors without additional protection may react with epitaxial deposition process chemistries. Therefore, quartz crystal monitors as described herein are configured to reduce reaction with epitaxial deposition process chemistries, which may negatively impact either sensor performance, sensor longevity, or process conditions within the process chamber. Coating the quartz crystal of the quartz crystal monitors reduces reaction of the quartz crystal with the process chemistries. Similarly, the use of gold containing contacts within the quartz crystal monitors reduces the chemical interaction of the sensor head metal with the process chemistries.

(12) The location and number of quartz crystal monitors provides increased sensitivity and sensor life cycles. The configuration of the exhaust system around the quartz crystal monitors further enables the gas flow within the process volume to remain the same or have minimal flow impact, while increasing process gas flow across the quartz crystal monitors to improve growth rate on the quartz crystal monitors. Therefore, the exhaust system may include configurations of fins and baffles to control gas flow rate. The fins, baffles, and other components of the exhaust system may further be formed from or coated with a material to increase heat retention of the process gas as the process gas flows through the exhaust system. This enables more predictable and enhanced film

growth on the quartz crystal monitors.

(13) Software algorithms within the process chamber controller take the growth rate measurements from the quartz crystal monitors and enable calibration of other sensors within the process chamber as well as process conditions within the process chamber to improve film thickness growth rates.

(14) FIG. 1 is a schematic illustration of a deposition chamber **100**, according to embodiments of the present disclosure. The deposition chamber **100** is an epitaxial deposition chamber. The deposition chamber **100** is utilized to grow an epitaxial film on a substrate, such as the substrate **102**. The deposition chamber **100** creates a cross-flow of precursors across the top surface **150** of the substrate **102**.

(15) The deposition chamber **100** includes an upper body **156**, a lower body **148** disposed below the upper body **156**, a flow module **112** disposed between the upper body **156** and the lower body **148**. The upper body **156**, the flow module **112**, and the lower body **148** form a chamber body. Disposed within the chamber body is a substrate support **106**, an upper window **108**, a lower window **110**, a plurality of upper lamps **141**, and a plurality of lower lamps **143**. As shown, the controller **120** is in communication with the deposition chamber **100** and is used to control processes, such as those described herein. The substrate support **106** is disposed between the upper window **108** and the lower window **110**. The plurality of upper lamps **141** are disposed between the upper window **108** and a lid **154**. The plurality of upper lamps **141** form a portion of the upper lamp module **155**. The lid **154** may include a plurality of sensors (not shown) disposed therein for measuring the temperature within the deposition chamber **100**. The plurality of lower lamps **143** are disposed between the lower window **110** and a floor **152**. The plurality of lower lamps **143** form a portion of a lower lamp module **145**. The upper window **108** is an upper dome and is formed of an energy transmissive material, such as quartz. The lower window **110** is a lower dome and is formed of an energy transmissive material, such as quartz.

(16) A process volume **136** is formed between the upper window **108** and the lower window **110**. The process volume **136** has the substrate support **106** disposed therein. The substrate support **106** includes a top surface on which the substrate **102** is disposed. The substrate support **106** is attached to a shaft **118**. The shaft is connected to a motion assembly **121**. The motion assembly **121** includes one or more actuators and/or adjustment devices that provide movement and/or adjustment of the shaft **118** and/or the substrate support **106** within the process volume **136**.

(17) The substrate support **106** may include lift pin holes **107** disposed therein. The lift pin holes **107** are sized to accommodate a lift pin **132** for lifting of the substrate **102** from the substrate support **106** either before or after a deposition process is performed. The lift pins **132** may rest on lift pin stops **134** when the substrate support **106** is lowered from a process position to a transfer position.

(18) The flow module **112** includes a plurality of process gas inlets **114**, a plurality of purge gas inlets **164**, and one or more exhaust gas outlets **116**. The plurality of process gas inlets **114** and the plurality of purge gas inlets **164** are disposed on the opposite side of the flow module **112** from the one or more exhaust gas outlets **116**. One or more flow guides are disposed below the plurality of process gas inlets **114** and the one or more exhaust gas outlets **116**. The flow guide is disposed above the purge gas inlets **164**. A liner **163** is disposed on the inner surface of the flow module **112** and protects the flow module **112** from reactive gases used during deposition processes. The process gas inlets **114** and the purge gas inlets **164** are positioned to flow a gas parallel to the top surface **150** of a substrate **102** disposed within the process volume **136**. The process gas inlets **114** are fluidly connected to a process gas source **151**. The purge gas inlets **164** are fluidly connected to a purge gas source **162**. The one or more exhaust gas outlets **116** are fluidly connected to an exhaust pump **157**.

(19) The one or more exhaust gas outlets **116** are further connected to or include an exhaust system **178**. The exhaust system **178** fluidly connects the one or more exhaust gas outlets **116** and the exhaust pump **157**. The exhaust system **178** as described herein includes one or more growth

monitors **310** (FIG. 3A) and is configured to assist in the controlled deposition of a layer on the substrate **102**.

(20) FIG. 2 illustrates a cross-sectional plan view of the deposition chamber **100** of FIG. 1, according to embodiments of the present disclosure. The deposition chamber **100** includes an injector **202** disposed across from the exhaust system **178**. The injector **202** includes the process gas inlets **114** and is fluidly coupled to the process gas source **151**. The injector **202** may be disposed through at least a portion of the flow module **112** or may be a part of the flow module **112**. The exhaust system **178** is disposed on the opposite side of the process volume **136** from the injector **202**. The exhaust system **178** is formed through, attached to, or a part of the flow module.

(21) The exhaust system **178** further includes at least one exhaust passage body **204a**, **204b**. The exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b** form an exhaust path for gas leaving the process volume **136** before entering an exhaust collector **206**. As shown in FIG. 2, there is a first exhaust passage body **204a** and a second exhaust passage body **204b**. The first exhaust passage body **204a** and the second exhaust passage body **204b** are mirror images and may be similar in size and configuration. In other embodiments, there may be more or less exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b**. In some embodiments, there is only one exhaust passage body, such that the two exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b** are merged into a single body. In yet other embodiments, there may be three or more exhaust passage bodies, such as three exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b**. The size and configuration of the exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b** may change depending upon the size and operation of the deposition chamber **100**.

(22) Both of the first exhaust passage body **204a** and the second exhaust passage body **204b** are coupled to the exhaust collector **206** on the opposite end of the exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b** from the process volume **136**. The exhaust collector **206** is configured to collect the exhaust from the first exhaust passage body **204a** and the second exhaust passage body **204b**. The exhaust collector **206** narrows as the exhaust collector **206** extends away from the exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b**.

(23) FIG. 3A illustrates a cross-sectional plan view of the exhaust system **178** of the deposition chamber **100** of FIG. 1, according to embodiments of the present disclosure. The exhaust system **178** is configured to control the exhaust gas flow exiting the process volume **136** before being flowed over one or more growth monitors **310**. Increased flow volume over the growth monitors **310** relative to the flow volume at the entrance to the exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b** enhances film growth on the growth monitors **310**. Therefore, the width of each of the exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b** is narrowed from an entry width $W_{sub.1}$ to an exit width $W_{sub.2}$ to enhance flow volume. A fin array **314** and one or more baffles **304** are positioned within each of the exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b** to enable the narrowing of the exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b**, while reducing the impact of the narrowing on the flow path of the process gases through the process volume **136**.

(24) As the process gas flows out of the process volume **136** and into the exhaust system **178**, the process gas is flowing in a first flow path **318**. The first flow path **318** is primarily parallel with the top surface **150** of the substrate **102** and the gas flow out of the injector **202**. The process gas is flowed into the exhaust system **178** through an exhaust entry opening **305a**, **305b** disposed through each of the exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b**. Therefore, a first exhaust entry opening **305a** is disposed through a first end of the first exhaust passage body **204a**, while a second exhaust entry opening **305b** is disposed through a first end of the second exhaust passage body **204b**. The exhaust entry openings **305a**, **205b** are in fluid communication with exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b**. The exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b** are disposed within each of the exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b**. Therefore, a first exhaust plenum **312a** is disposed within the first exhaust passage body **204a** and a second exhaust plenum **312b** is disposed within the second exhaust passage body **204b**. The first exhaust entry opening **305a** is in fluid communication with the first exhaust plenum **312a** and the second exhaust entry opening **305b** is in fluid communication with the second exhaust plenum

312b.

(25) Each of the exhaust entry openings **305a**, **305b** have an entry width $W_{sub.1}$. The entry width $W_{sub.1}$ is about 10 mm to about 210 mm, such as about 45 mm to about 210 mm, such as about 75 mm to about 175 mm, such as about 100 mm to about 155 mm. The entry width $W_{sub.1}$ is therefore less than or equal to half of the width of the process volume **136**.

(26) An exhaust exit opening **308a**, **308b** is disposed on the opposite side of the exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b** from the exhaust entry openings **305a**, **305b**. Therefore, a first exhaust exit opening **308a** is disposed on a second side of the first exhaust passage body **204a** opposite the first side and in fluid communication with the first exhaust plenum **312a**. The second exhaust exit opening **308b** is disposed on a second side of the second exhaust passage body **204b** opposite the first side and in fluid communication with the second exhaust plenum **312b**. The exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b** are smaller in width than the exhaust entry openings **305a**, **305b**. The exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b** have an exit width $W_{sub.2}$ of about 15 mm to about 110 mm, such as about 20 mm to about 100 mm, such as about 20 mm to about 40 mm. The exit width $W_{sub.2}$ being smaller than the entry width $W_{sub.1}$ enables a higher concentration of process gases to flow over the growth monitors **310**.

(27) The ratio of the entry width $W_{sub.1}$ to the exit width $W_{sub.2}$ is about 2:1 to about 20:1, such as about 3:1 to about 10:1, such as about 4:1 to about 8:1. The ratio of the entry width $W_{sub.1}$ to the exit width $W_{sub.2}$ enables good film growth on the growth monitors **310**, while reducing the impact of the reduced exit width $W_{sub.2}$ on backpressure and flow path through the process volume **136**.

(28) Process gases flowing through the deposition chamber **100** enter the exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b** through the exhaust entry openings **305a**, **305b** while in the first flow path **318** before changing to a second flow path **320** as one or more baffles **304** narrows the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b** to the exit width $W_{sub.2}$ adjacent the exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b**. The second flow path **320** brings the process gases towards a center line C of the exhaust system and towards one side of the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b**, such as the inner side of the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b**. Once the process gases are flowed through the exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b**, the path of the process gases is changes to a third flow path **322**. The third flow path **322** is a condensed flow path. The third flow path **322** is disposed through the collector plenum **316**. The collector plenum **316** is a plenum disposed within the exhaust collector **206**.

(29) The fin arrays **314** disposed within each of the exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b** are configured to maintain the first flow path **318** through at least a portion of the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b**. The fin arrays **314** include a plurality of fins **302**, such that a first plurality of fins **302** are disposed within the first exhaust plenum **312a** of the first exhaust passage body **204a**. Each of the first plurality of fins **302** extends from the first exhaust entry opening **305a** towards the first exhaust exit opening **308a**. A second plurality of fins **302** are disposed within the second exhaust plenum **312b** and the second exhaust passage body **204b**. Each of the second plurality of fins **302** extends from the second exhaust entry opening **305b** towards the second exhaust exit opening **308b**. The fin arrays **314** are configured to maintain good flow control through the process volume **136** and extend from a position adjacent to the exhaust entry openings **305a**, **305b**.

(30) The number of fins **302** within the fin arrays **314** may be at least two fins **302**, such as at least four fins **302**, such as at least 5 fins **302**, such as 5 fins **302** to about 30 fins **302**, such as 5 fins **302** to about 20 fins **302**. The number of fins **302** assists in creating smaller gaps between each adjacent fin **302** and control of the first flow path **318**.

(31) One or more growth monitors **310** are disposed within the fin arrays **314**, such as between two adjacent fins **302**. There may be two or more growth monitors **310** disposed within each fin array **314** of both the first exhaust passage body **204a** and the second exhaust passage body **204b**. The growth monitors **310** within the fin arrays **314** may assist in providing measurements of the growth rate at different radial positions on the substrate **102**.

(32) Each of the fins **302** within the fin arrays **314** are parallel to one another. The fins **302** extend in a direction parallel to the desired first flow path **318** and parallel to the gas flowing out of the injector **202**. Other configurations of the fin arrays **314** are contemplated. In some embodiments, each of the fins **302** are a similar length. In other embodiments, each of the fins **302** are not necessarily the same length, such that fins **302** closer to the centerline C of the process volume **136** and the exhaust system **178** are shorter than fins **302** further from the centerline C.

(33) Once the process gases leave the fin arrays **314**, the process gases are flown into the main portion **311** of the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b**. The main portion **311** of the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b** is an open space and may assist in reducing backpressure which would build up if the fin arrays **314** extended all the way to the baffles **304**. In some embodiments, there is a gap of at least 5 mm between the end of the fin arrays **314** and the closest portion of the baffle **304**, such as about 5 mm to about 40 mm.

(34) The baffles **304** extends from an outer surface **328** of each of the exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b** and towards an inner surface **330** of each of the exhaust passage bodies **204a**, **204b**. The outer surface **328** is the inside surface of the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b** furthest from the centerline C. The inner surface **330** is the inside surface of the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b** closest to the centerline C. Therefore, the baffle **304** within the first exhaust passage body **204a** extends from the outer surface **328** of the first exhaust plenum **312a** and towards the inner surface **330** of the first exhaust plenum **312a** or the centerline C of the exhaust system **178**. The baffle **304** within the second exhaust passage body **204b** extends from the outer surface **328** of the second exhaust plenum **312b** and towards the inner surface **330** of the second exhaust plenum **312b** or the centerline C of the exhaust system **178**.

(35) The baffles **304** extends at an angle ϕ with respect to the outer surface **328** of each of the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b**. The angle ϕ is the inside angle facing the fin array **314**. The angle ϕ is an obtuse angle, such that the angle ϕ is greater than about 90 degrees, such as about 100 degrees to about 170 degrees, such as about 100 degrees to about 160 degrees, such as about 110 degrees to about 145 degrees. The angle at which the baffle plate **304** is disposed assists in controlling the rate of restriction of the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b**. The baffle plates **304** are disposed at an angle other than 0 degrees or 90 degrees with respect to the orientation of the fins **302**, such as between about 10 degrees and about 80 degrees with respect to the orientation of the fins **302**. The baffle plates **304** extend across over 50% of the width of each of the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b**, such as over 60% of the width of each of the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b**, such as over 70% of the width of each of the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b**. In some embodiments, the baffle plates **304** have a radius of curvature defined as the radius from the center of the process volume **136** of the deposition chamber **100** to a gas guide surface **332**. In some embodiments, the radius of curvature changes across the gas guide surface **332**, such that the portion of the gas guide surface **332** closer to the inner surfaces **330** has a smaller radius of curvature. The radius of curvature of the gas guide surface **332** may also be other radii other than the radius from the center of the process volume **136**. Each baffle plate **304** has a gas guide surface **332**. The gas guide surface **332** is the surface of the baffle plate **304** facing the main portion **311** of the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b** as well as the fin arrays **314**.

(36) The baffles **304** may have either a curved gas guide surface **332**, a straight gas guide surface **332**, or a multi-faceted gas guide surface **332**. The gas guide surface **332** is shown as being curved in FIG. 3A, but may be straight in some embodiments. In curved embodiments, the gas guide surface **332** follows a circumference of a circle, an ellipse, a hyperbola, or a parabola. A curved surface allows for better gas flow control with reduced eddying or turbulence within the gas flow path.

(37) The curvature of the gas guide surface **332** may vary depending upon the size of the deposition chamber **100** and the size of the exhaust system **178**. The gas guide surface **332** having a large radius of curvature enables smooth guidance of gas flow through the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b**.

(38) The exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b** are disposed between an innermost portion of each of the baffles **304** and the inner surface **330** of each of the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b**. The first exhaust exit opening **308a** is disposed within the first exhaust plenum **312a** and connects the first exhaust plenum **312a** to the collector plenum **316**. The second exhaust exit opening **308b** is disposed within the second exhaust plenum **312b** and connects the second exhaust plenum **312b** to the collector plenum **316**.

(39) One or more growth monitors **310** are located either within the exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b** or just downstream of the exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b**. A first growth monitor **310** is disposed within the first exhaust exit opening **308a** or just downstream of the exhaust exit opening **308a**. A second growth monitor **310** is disposed within the second exhaust exit opening **308b** or just downstream of the second exhaust exit opening **308b**. The growth monitors **310** being disposed just downstream of the exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b** is defined as the growth monitors **310** being disposed within 10 mm of the exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b** and away from the fin arrays **314**.

(40) The baffles **304** narrow the passage through which exhaust gases pass through the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b** and therefore increase the density or concentration of the exhaust gases flowing over the growth monitors **310**. The growth monitors **310** are disposed in either a top surface **326** or a bottom surface **327** (FIG. 3B) of the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b** so that the growth monitors **310** do not block the third flow path **322**, but are instead disposed in line with the third flow path **322**. The growth monitors **310** are located at least partially inside of the collector plenum **316**.

(41) Exhaust gas passes over the growth monitors **310** and into the collector plenum **316** before being removed from the exhaust collector **206** through a conduit opening **306** of the exhaust conduit **323** (FIG. 3B). The width of the collector plenum **316** adjacent to the exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b** is wider than the exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b**, such that the width of the collector plenum **316** adjacent to each of the exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b** is similar to the entry width $W_{sub.1}$ and the total width of the collector plenum **316** is similar to or greater than two times the entry width $W_{sub.1}$.

(42) The conduit opening **306** is disposed at a portion of the collector plenum **316** opposite the exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b**. The conduit opening **306** is configured to enable venting of the exhaust gas within the exhaust collector **206** through an exhaust conduit **323** and to an exhaust pump **157**. Adjacent to the conduit opening **306** and within the collector plenum **316** is another growth monitor **310**. The growth monitor **310** adjacent to the conduit opening **306** is disposed on a back sidewall **321** (FIG. 3B) of the collector plenum **316** furthest from the exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b**. In some embodiments, the growth monitor **310** is disposed directly above the conduit opening **306** or within the conduit opening **306**, such as within an upper portion of the exhaust conduit **323**.

(43) At least the fins **302** and the baffles **304** are formed from or coated with a material with a high thermal conductivity, such as a material with a thermal conductivity of above about 100 W/m.Math. ° K, such as above about 150 W/m.Math. ° K, such as above about 175 W/m.Math. ° K. The material of the fins **302** is chosen to reduce contamination of the deposition chamber **100** while also maintaining the temperature of the exhaust gas flowing through the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b** before flowing over the growth monitors **310**. In some embodiments, at least a portion of the wall forming the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b** is coated in the high thermal conductivity material similar to the fins **302** and the baffles **304**. The inside of the exhaust collector **206** may similarly be coated in the high thermal conductivity material. The high thermal conductivity material may be silicon carbide (SiC). Other suitable high thermal conductivity materials are contemplated. In some embodiments, the fins **302** and the baffles **304** are formed of graphite and coated with silicon carbide. The high thermal conductivity material conducts heat from the process volume **136** and reduces the rate of cooling of exhaust gases flowed through the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b**. Keeping the exhaust gases heated before being flowed over the growth monitors **310** enables more

consistent film formation on the growth monitors **310** to provide more accurate estimates of film growth rates within the process chamber.

(44) FIG. **3B** illustrates a cross-sectional side view of the exhaust system **178** of the deposition chamber **100** of FIG. **1**, according to embodiments of the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. **3B**, the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b** of the exhaust system **178** extend through at least a portion of the flow module **112**, such that the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b** extend through the flow module **112**. The fins **302** are disposed adjacent to the process volume **136**.

(45) The fins **302** and the baffles **304** extend the full height of the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b**, such that the fins **302** and the baffles **304** extend between the top surface **326** and the bottom surface **329** of the exhaust plenums **312a**, **312b**. The growth monitors within the fin arrays **314** are disposed on the top surface **326**.

(46) The exhaust collector **206** is connected to the back end of the exhaust system **178**. The exhaust collector **206** includes a top surface **324**, a bottom surface **327**, and a back sidewall **321**. The growth monitors **310** just downstream of the exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b** are positioned on the top surface **324** of the collector plenum **316** within the exhaust collector **206**. Another growth monitor **310** is disposed on the back sidewall **321** of the collector plenum **316**. The positioning of the growth monitors **310** enables accurate film growth rate measurements by each of the growth monitors **310**. The measurements from each of the growth monitors **310** may be mapped to see differences in growth rate across different positions of the substrate **102**.

(47) The conduit opening **306** is disposed through the bottom surface **327** of the collector plenum **316** and opens into the exhaust conduit **323**. The exhaust conduit **323** extends downward from the conduit opening **306** and is fluidly connected to the exhaust pump **157**. Another growth monitor **310** may be positioned on an inner wall of the exhaust conduit **323** downstream of the growth monitor **310** on the back sidewall **321** of the collector plenum **316**.

(48) In some embodiments, more or less growth monitors **310** may be utilized within the exhaust system **178**. In some embodiments, only the growth monitors **310** adjacent to the exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b** are disposed within the exhaust system **178**. In other embodiments, the growth monitors **310** adjacent to the exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b** may be a single growth monitor **310**. In yet other embodiments, the growth monitors **310** adjacent to the exhaust exit openings **308a**, **308b** and the growth monitor **310** on the back sidewall **321** of the collector plenum **316** are utilized.

(49) FIG. **4** illustrates a growth monitor **310** for use within the deposition chamber **100** of FIG. **1**, according to embodiments of the present disclosure. The growth monitor **310** includes a sensor holder **402**, a quartz crystal **406** disposed within the sensor holder **402**, a back contact **408** contacting a first side **422** of the quartz crystal **406**, a front contact **410** contacting a second side **424** of the quartz crystal **406**, a protective coating **416** disposed on the second side **424** of the quartz crystal **406**, and a sensor opening **414** disposed through the sensor holder **402** and exposing the protective coating **416** to gases flowing through the exhaust system **178**.

(50) The growth monitors **310** are configured to be positioned within the deposition chamber **100** and therefore account for the reactive process chemistries within the exhaust system **178**. The protective coating **416** as well as the material of the sensor holder **402**, the back contact **408**, and the front contact **410** impact the reactivity of the growth monitors **310** with the process chemistries within the deposition chamber **100**. Therefore, material compositions are chosen which reduce the reactivity of the growth monitor **310** with the process chemistries within the deposition chamber **100**, while still enabling accurate film thickness measurements on the growth monitors **310**.

(51) The sensor holder **402** acts as a case in which the back contact **408**, the front contact **410**, and the quartz crystal **406** are disposed. The sensor holder **402** is formed in multiple parts, such as a first part **405** and a second part **404**. The first part **405** has a cavity formed therein in which the back contact **408** is located. The quartz crystal **406** is also located within the cavity and contacting the back contact **408**.

(52) The second part **404** includes the sensor opening **414** disposed therethrough and is positioned over the side of the first part **405**, which includes the cavity. The front contact **410** is positioned between the first part **405** and the second part **404**. The front contact **410** is held in place by the gripping force of the first part **405** and the second part **404**. The front contact **410** is a ring, such that the front contact **410** covers an outer portion of the second side **424** of the quartz crystal **406**, but not a central portion of the second side **424**. The protective coating **416** is disposed within the ring formed by the front contact **410** and contacts the second side **424** of the quartz crystal **406**. The protective coating **416** is at least partially disposed within the sensor opening **414**, such that the protective coating **416** is exposed to the exhaust gases flowed through the exhaust system **178**. The protective coating **416** and the quartz crystal **406** are held in place at least in part by the gripping force between the first part **405** and the second part **404**. One or more sealing rings **412** are disposed within the second part **404** and contact the exposed surface **426** of the protective coating **416**. The one or more sealing rings **412** are configured to provide a seal between the atmosphere within the exhaust system **178** and the other components of the growth monitor **310** which are not the protective coating **416**.

(53) The protective coating **416** is formed from one of alumina (Al.sub.2O.sub.3) or a silicon oxide, such as silicon dioxide (SiO.sub.2). The protective coating **416** is formed from a material which does not degrade when exposed to epitaxial deposition process conditions or process gases. The protective coating **416** may be a lens or may be a coating applied to the quartz crystal **406**. The protective coating **416** has a thickness of less than about 10 μm , such as about 1 nm to about 10 nm, such as about 1 nm to about 5 nm. The small thickness enables protection of the quartz crystal **406** without significant damping of the oscillation of the quartz crystal **406**.

(54) At least one of the back contact **408** or the front contact **410** are formed from a gold containing material, such as a gold alloy or pure gold. Both of the back contact **408** and the front contact **410** may be formed from a gold containing material. The gold containing material reduces the reaction of the back contact **408** and the front contact **410** to the process chemistries within the deposition chamber **100**. In some embodiments, the back contact **408** and the front contact **410** are coated in a gold containing material.

(55) A cooling mechanism **420** is disposed through the first part **405** of the sensor holder **402**. The cooling mechanism **420** may be a coolant passage disposed through the body of the first part **405**. The cooling mechanism **420** may be a coolant passage configured to receive cooling water.

(56) The one or more sealing rings **412** are formed from a polymer or plastic compatible with epitaxial deposition processes at a temperature of about 200° C. In some embodiments, the one or more sealing rings **412** may be an o-ring or another type of gasket.

(57) FIG. 5 illustrates a control schematic **500** for use within the deposition chamber **100** of FIG. 1, according to embodiments of the present disclosure. The controller **120** is configured to receive data or input as sensor readings **502** from each of the growth monitors **310**. The controller **120** is equipped with or in communication with a system model **506** of the deposition chamber **100**. The system model **506** includes a heating model and a gas flow module. The system model **506** is a program configured to estimate the gas flow and heating within the deposition chamber **100** throughout a deposition process. The controller **120** is further configured to store readings and calculations **504**.

(58) The readings and calculations **504** include previous sensor readings **502**, such as any previous sensor readings within the deposition chamber **100**. The readings and calculations **504** further include the stored calculated values from after the sensor readings **502** are measured by the controller **120** and run through the system model **506**. Therefore, the controller **120** is configured to both retrieve stored readings and calculations **504** as well as save readings and calculations **504** for future use. Maintaining previous readings and calculations enables the controller **120** to adjust the system model **506** over time to reflect a more accurate version of the deposition chamber **100**.

(59) In embodiments described herein, the controller **120** includes a programmable central

processing unit (CPU) that is operated with a memory and a mass storage device, an input control unit, and a display unit (not shown). The controller **120** monitors the precursor, process gas, and purge gas flow. Support circuits are coupled to the CPU for supporting the processor in a conventional manner. In some embodiments, the controller **120** includes multiple controllers **120**, such that the stored readings and calculations **504** and the system model **506** are stored within a separate controller from the controller **120** which operates the deposition chamber **100**. In other embodiments, all of the system model **506** and the stored readings and calculations **504** are saved within the controller **120**.

(60) The controller **120** is configured to control the heating and gas flow through the deposition chamber **100** by providing an output to the lamps and gas flow controls **508**. The lamps and gas flow controls **508** include the upper lamps **141**, the lower lamps **143**, the process gas source **151**, the purge gas source **162**, and the exhaust pump **157**. The controller **120** may also control the motion assembly **121** within the deposition chamber **100**.

(61) The controller **120** is configured to adjust the output to each of the lamps and gas flow controls **508** based off of the sensor readings **502**, the system model **506**, and the stored readings and calculations **504**. The controller **120** includes embedded software and a compensation algorithm to calibrate growth monitor **310** frequency shift to the film thickness on the substrate **102**. The film thickness on the substrate **102** may be measured as the substrate **102** leaves the deposition chamber or between process operations to provide a reference for film thickness growth rates measured using the growth monitors **310**. The controller **120** may include a machine learning algorithm and may use a regression or clustering technique. The algorithm is an unsupervised or a supervised algorithm.

(62) FIG. **6** illustrates a method **600** of adjusting process conditions within the deposition chamber **100** of FIG. **1**, according to embodiments of the present disclosure. The method **600** utilizes the growth monitors **310** within the deposition chamber **100** as well as the controller **120** described herein to improve film thickness uniformity and properties across the substrate **102**.

(63) During the method **600**, a first substrate is processed within a processing chamber during an operation **602**. The first substrate may be the substrate **102** and the processing chamber is the deposition chamber **100**. Processing the first substrate during the operation **602** includes performing a deposition process on the first substrate, such as an epitaxial deposition process. The deposition process grows a film over the first substrate and includes heating the substrate using the upper lamps **141** and the lower lamps **143**. Gas is flown through the process volume **136** from the process gas inlets **114** and the purge gas inlets **164** before being removed through the exhaust gas outlets **116**.

(64) As the first substrate is being processed within the processing chamber, the growth monitors **310** are used to measure the film thickness growth on the monitors during another operation **604**. The measuring of the film thickness growth on the growth monitors **310** is performed as a rolling operation. A controller, such as the controller **120**, is configured to receive input from a combination of the growth monitors **310** described with respect to FIGS. **3A-3B**. The input is used to estimate film growth on the first substrate. Once the first substrate is done being processed within the processing chamber, the film thickness may be measured using one or more other non-contact sensors within the processing chamber or within an adjacent chamber during another operation **606**. Measuring the film growth on the first substrate during the operation **606** is performed in a non-destructive manner, such as by using one or more non-contact sensors. The non-contact sensors may be a laser thickness gauge and may take multiple discreet measurements across the surface of the first substrate or may scan a length of the first substrate.

(65) The non-contact sensors used during the operation **606** are not necessarily utilized for film thickness measurement during substrate processing as the process gases and radiation from the heating sources interfere with sensor readings to reduce reading sensitivity and precision. Therefore, the ability to determine and administer changes to heating and gas flow within a process

volume during substrate processing is limited using the non-contact sensors utilized during the operation **606**. The growth monitors **310** beneficially enable adjustment of the process conditions, such as heating and gas flow, while the first substrate is being processed.

(66) The measurements of the film growth on the first substrate enables the growth rate on the first substrate to be calculated during another operation **608**. Calculating the growth rate on the first substrate during the operation **608** verifies the accuracy of the models used within the controller and enables the processing chamber model to be adjusted during another operation **610**. Adjusting the processing chamber model during the operation **610** enables better use of the growth monitors **310** for a specific process. Once the model has been adjusted, processing of another substrate, such as a second substrate, is performed and the operations **602**, **604**, **606**, **608**, **610** are repeated. The operations **602**, **604**, **606**, **608**, **610** of the method **600** may be looped to continuously adjust the accuracy of the processing chamber model during operation **610** and improve film thickness growth results. When preventative maintenance is performed on the processing chamber, the processing chamber model may be reset or adjusted and the method **600** begins again. Therefore, film thickness results are improved continuously between each substrate. This further enables accurate film thickness and overcomes changes in processing chamber properties as films build up on surfaces within the process volume and as lamps age.

(67) While the foregoing is directed to embodiments of the present disclosure, other and further embodiments of the disclosure may be devised without departing from the basic scope thereof, and the scope thereof is determined by the claims that follow.

Claims

1. An exhaust passage body applicable for semiconductor substrate processing, comprising: a first exhaust plenum; a first exhaust entry opening formed through a first end of the exhaust passage body and fluidly connected to the first exhaust plenum; a first plurality of fins disposed adjacent to the first exhaust entry opening within the first exhaust plenum; a first exhaust exit opening formed through a second end of the exhaust passage body and fluidly connected to the first exhaust plenum; a first baffle plate disposed adjacent to the first exhaust exit opening and configured to narrow a first width of the first exhaust plenum; and at least one growth monitor disposed downstream of the first baffle plate and configured to measure a thickness of a material deposited on the at least one growth monitor.
2. The exhaust passage body of claim 1, wherein the at least one growth monitor is a quartz crystal film thickness monitor.
3. The exhaust passage body claim 1, wherein the first baffle plate is oriented to narrow the first exhaust plenum as the first exhaust plenum extends towards the first exhaust exit opening.
4. The exhaust passage body of claim 3, further comprising: a second exhaust plenum; a second exhaust entry opening formed through the first end of the exhaust passage body and fluidly connected to the second exhaust plenum; a second plurality of fins disposed adjacent to the second exhaust entry opening within the second exhaust plenum; a second exhaust exit opening formed through the second end of the exhaust passage body and fluidly connected to the second exhaust plenum; and a second baffle plate disposed adjacent to the second exhaust exit opening and configured to narrow a second width of the second exhaust plenum.
5. The exhaust passage body of claim 1, wherein the first exhaust entry opening has an entry width and the first exhaust exit opening has an exit width, a ratio of the entry width to the exit width being about 2:1 to about 20:1.
6. The exhaust passage body of claim 5, wherein the entry width of the first exhaust entry opening is about 10 mm to about 210 mm.
7. The exhaust passage body of claim 1, wherein the first plurality of fins includes at least four fins.
8. The exhaust passage body of claim 7, wherein each of the first plurality of fins are oriented

parallel to one another.

9. An exhaust system applicable for semiconductor substrate processing, comprising: an exhaust passage body comprising: an exhaust plenum; an exhaust entry opening formed through a first end of the exhaust passage body and having an entry width; a plurality of fins disposed adjacent to the exhaust entry opening within the exhaust plenum; an exhaust exit opening formed through a second end of the exhaust passage body and fluidly connected to the exhaust plenum; at least one baffle plate disposed adjacent to the exhaust exit opening and configured to narrow a width of the exhaust plenum to an exit width less than the entry width; and at least one growth monitor disposed downstream of the at least one baffle plate and configured to measure a thickness of a material deposited on the at least one growth monitor; and an exhaust collector coupled to the exhaust passage body at the exhaust exit opening.

10. The exhaust system of claim 9, wherein the at least one growth monitor is a quartz crystal film thickness monitor.

11. The exhaust system of claim 10, wherein the quartz crystal film thickness monitor comprises: a sensor holder; a quartz crystal disposed within the sensor holder; a back contact contacting a first side of the quartz crystal; a front contact contacting a second side of the quartz crystal; a protective coating disposed on the second side of the quartz crystal; and a sensor opening disposed through the sensor holder and exposing the protective coating to gases flowing through the exhaust plenum.

12. The exhaust system of claim 11, wherein at least one of the back contact and the front contact comprise a gold material.

13. The exhaust system of claim 11, wherein the protective coating is alumina or silicon dioxide.

14. The exhaust system of claim 9, wherein the plurality of fins are a material with a thermal conductivity of above about 100 W/m.K.

15. The exhaust system of claim 14, wherein the material contains silicon carbide.

16. The exhaust system of claim 9, wherein the at least one growth monitor is disposed within the exhaust collector adjacent to the exhaust exit opening.

17. The exhaust system of claim 9, wherein the at least one baffle plate is a curved plate.

18. A process system applicable for semiconductor substrate processing, comprising: a chamber body forming a process volume; a substrate support disposed within the process volume of the chamber body; an upper window disposed above the substrate support; a lower window disposed below the substrate support, wherein each of the upper window and the lower window further define the process volume; an injector disposed through one side of the chamber body and configured to introduce a process gas to the process volume; an exhaust system disposed through a second side of the chamber body opposite the injector and comprising: an exhaust passage body; an exhaust plenum disposed through the exhaust passage body; an exhaust entry opening formed through a first end of the exhaust passage body, the exhaust entry opening configured to fluidly connect the exhaust plenum and the process volume; a plurality of fins disposed within the exhaust plenum; an exhaust exit opening formed through a second end of the exhaust passage body and fluidly connected to the exhaust plenum; at least one baffle plate disposed downstream of the plurality of fins and configured to narrow a width of the exhaust plenum to an exit width less than an entry width; and at least one growth monitor disposed downstream of the at least one baffle plate and configured to measure a thickness of a material deposited on the at least one growth monitor.

19. The process system of claim 18, wherein the at least one growth monitor is in communication with a controller configured to determine growth rates on the at least one growth monitor and adjust at least one of process gas flow rates, heating energy levels, or exhaust flow rates.

20. The process system of claim 19, wherein the controller compares measured growth rates on the at least one growth monitor, a chamber thermal model, a chamber flow model, and previous monitor measurements to determine how to adjust at least one of the process gas flow rates, the heating energy levels, or the exhaust flow rates.

